

CAPUCHIN FRANCISCAN

PAX ET BONUM

ST. FELIX FRIARY

FATHERS

HUNTINGTON, INDIANA

March 5th, 1955. Forty Martyrs.

Blessed be God in all His designs

Mrs. Veronica Sullivan McCarthy
2171 Bewick Avenue
Detroit, Michigan.

God bless you Mrs. Sullivan McCarthy. God bless you and yours these days, at once of threatening forebodings and of God's outstanding mercies. I hope this finds you all well. I started to write you several times since receiving your letter of about a month ago. Somehow I did not realize how simple and modest was your request till this Morning when I read it over again. Please pardon my oversight, etc and my consequent delay. I hope the following may not be without purpose.

Yes: of course I remember you and your whole Sullivan Famile, and that, not without pleasant and grateful memories. I did not know your Husband McCarthy so well. I believe he was known as quite a genius with pencil and brush. I had not known of your marriage, (which had taken place according to your recent letter, on January 26th 1949), till you came down to Saint Felix shortly after as I would naturally suppose, with Mr. McCarthy and your Sister Myrtle and introduced the former as you Husband. I was glad at the announcement, etc, But whether I must have sensed something lame about the wedding affair, (which I hardly think I did), I do remember a sort of embarrassment which I experienced momentarily just then, on account of my own unwanted apathy. At all events, your lament shortly afterwards, concerning your Husband's trouble, (impotentia sexualis), seemed more or less like a mysterious key for that unwonted, halfhearted congratulation.

I surely felt sorry for both of you. I cannot but sympathize with any one so hampered, whose state in life and consequent obligations, as well as, to a great extent, whose privileged duties and laudable joys and pleasures presuppose just such-we may say-vital faculties. Otherwise of course, they may be altogether secondary, nonessential and their absence, in many cases at least nothing less than a relief from weighty obligations. In fact, Church history and the Lives of the Saints abound in examples just such and similar weaknesses - which incidently, is liable to come to anyone - has been the last tie in the world from a complete break with worldness and a positive, determined "take-off for Heavenly existence.

Please Pardon Abruptness

Fr. Solanus, O.F.M.Cap.